"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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Filmed on location (tour map):
Pacific Northwest: Bellingham, WA; Semiahmoo, Blaine, WA; Stanwood, WA; Maryhill Memorial, WA; White Pass WA; Chelan WA; Plymouth WA; Mount Hood Meadows, OR; White River Snow Park, Mt. Hood, OR; Hood River, OR; Bend, OR; Three Mile Canyon, OR; **California, Nevada:** BLM, Susanville, CA; Oroville, CA; Washoe Lake, NV; Rye Patch, NV; Pine Flat Lake, CA; Lake Cahuilla La Quinta, CA; Barstow, CA; French Camp, Tom's Place, CA; **Idaho, Montana, Wyoming**: Coeur d'Alene, ID; Twin Falls ID; Murtough Lake, ID; 3 Island Crossing, ID; Scotch Pines GC, ID; Rigby, ID; Missoula MT; Billings, MT; Clark Canyon Res, MT; Rocky Point, Belle Fourche, MT; Casper WY; **Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona:** Piute Reservoir, UT; Jordanelle Reservoir, UT; Bald Mountain, UT; Bonneville Salt Flats, UT; Little Salt Lake UT; Sand Hollow, Hurricane, UT; Purgatory Resort, CO; Longmont, CO; Chatfield State Park, Littleton, CO; Grand Junction, CO; Albuquerque, NM; Bottomless Lakes, Roswell, NM; Caballo Lake, NM; Elephant Butte, NM; VLA Radio Observatory, NM; Lake Pleasant, AZ; Homolovi Ruins, AZ; Scottsdale, AZ; BLM, Tusayan AZ; BLM, Quartzsite, AZ; Potato Patch CG, Jerome, AZ; Porter Spring, Roosevelt, AZ; Apache Gold, San Carlos, AZ; Roper Lake State Park, AZ; Fool Hollow, Show Low, AZ; **Kansas, Nebraska, South Dakota:**; Wichita KS; Lake Kanopolis, KS; Wilson Lake, KS; Lewis & Clark Rec Area, Yankton, SD; Platte Creek Rec Area, SD; Badlands National Park, SD; Lake Mcconaughy NE; **Oklahoma, Texas:** Oklahoma City, OK; Bear Creek Cove, OK; Lake Texoma, OK/TX; Tulsa, OK; Lawton, OK; Wichita Falls, TX; Lake Lavon, TX; Littlefield, TX; Van Horn, TX; Palmetto S.P., TX; League City, TX; Yegua Creek, Somerville, TX; Waco, TX; Lake Whitney, TX; Canyon Lake, TX; Clear Lake, Princeton, TX; Cedar Hill State Park, TX;

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*The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It's a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.*

*After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.*

***Remember your first journey?** I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word 'Fiat' itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience '**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**' The discovery of the Fiat's symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.*

Let Scotomaville guide you on your 'Personal Everest,' empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

April 27, 2024



AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; ***"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*** *He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He's demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.*

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

- ***BACKGROUND - WWDWWD***

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know ***"Why We Do What We Do."*** *and are committed to exploring the unknown... to 'Know Thyself'. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.*

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. [1] Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents [2]. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We're further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. [3] [4]

We're hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. [5] The adage to 'Know Thyself' is no longer a luxury. It's become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. [6]

■ *METHODS - IMPARTATION*

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:
Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal 'journey with purpose'. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:
The program is more than just watching; it's engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:
The Scotomaville journey doesn't end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program's licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ *FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING*

By climbing a 'Personal Everest' and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with ***"unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way"*** *(9) you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.*

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one's physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one's beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ *CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST*

A 'Personal Everest' is a journey with a purpose. ***"But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began..."***

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager (10)

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

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(1) https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/

(2) https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/

(5) https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team

(6) https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked

(7) https://intelligentnetware.com

(8) https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager

What follows achievement for most people? More? Most likely not.

sa • tis • fac • tion

Being on a Hedonic Treadmill means that no matter how much you acquire, no matter how much success and wealth and fame – "you can't get no" satisfaction. It's a n unsatisfying thirst for more, more, and more.

2.11

Hedonic Treadmill: "I cant get..." more success, and wealth and fame.

Do you think it's windy? Just when I need to do an opening scene for this episode!

Just five bars of music and you know the word [music]

'sa • tis • fac • tion'

Sometimes you try your hardest, and everything fights you for it - like making progress up your Personal Everest.

Welcome to this episode of SCOTOMAVILLE on satisfaction - being content and not being stuck on that Hedonic Treadmill.

Hedonic Treadmill?

What huh? You know. That's where no matter how much you acquire, no matter how much success and wealth and fame, or all that - "you can't get no" satisfaction.

The wiki explanation of satisfaction can leave you bewildered.

Satisfaction means you've had enough — in a good way. It's akin to being at ease in one's situation, body and mind - in the midst of imperfection.



- *Confidence*
- *Celebration*
- *Self-care*

These ingredients create a fabulously satisfying sense of empowerment, and help dull the edges of repeated failure.

However, from my expedition of awareness over 15 years, I've found three factors that lead toward a feeling of satisfaction - of contentment.

One is just being confident. Two, the celebration of what you're experiencing, and third, self-care. Those three things make a big difference for me. So I hope they do with you.



BY SIMMERING ON THE PROBLEM
It finally occurred to me the OLD solution of an ice box would work with a brand new challenge. I just had to let my brain simmer on it.

FAILING WITH GRACE

There's a simple saying; "the true test of genius is whether you can explain complex things in simple terms." I think if you review some of the prior episodes, you'll discover that I am far from a genius! However, I have learned to fail with grace and not give up. ***My worst efforts are better than not taking action.*** *For example, I could not think of the word confidence.*

Here's my evidence:

Considering events around the globe, it may seem insignificant to be grateful, content, and satisfied on just solving a minor problem - like your electric refrigerator sucking your batteries dry.

You are looking at Ziploc bags full of water, completely frozen solid. Guess what is not going to defrost on this trip!

So, I find that problem solving breeds contentment.

I'm both relieved and... Um... I need to go to my emotional vocabulary list. There's a word in there that I cannot bring to mind. I hope you can because it... It's not coming to MY mind.

[Pause]

I can almost see it and sense what it is but I can't connect the impression to my mouth.

(Turning to Angelina)

Ms. emotional positivity: *What is the word I am feeling for having solved that icebox problem?*

Angelina: *"Confidence!"*

I have to say things multiple times to distill my point. I want for you to start thinking...

*"**If Daniel and Angelina could do it, then maybe so can I.**"*

I'm trying to say; you can achieve your goals. Even failure is progress, so don't quit. Allow your brain/gut to simmer. Turn down the heat. Take it off the burner. Walk it off. Just don't quit.

SMASHING MY NOSE

After three seasons of failing to conquer my wind foiling jibes, I was able to order a custom foiling board. As soon as I started riding it, an old tendon in my mast base failed, and the mast then smashed the nose of the board. That was...heartbreaking. I was confident to take action by sanding it out, finding the right color paint, and fixing it because I had repaired an old Isonic carbon fiber board numerous times. I had prior experience as a foundation for repairing my new, expensive, custom board. I did not 'shy' away from the challenge or ignore that it needed work. I took action with confidence. The amateur effort yielded much personal satisfaction.





"Too little time to identify and express a complex issue leads to frustration and outbursts. Allow yourself to simmer on it"

CONFIRMATION BIAS SABOTAGES US:
We feel pressure to express emotions before consequences are delivered. Patience. Let it simmer.



A FROZEN PETCOCK

I discovered dripping water from a cracked freshwater tank drain petcock. So even though the wind was blowing hard, I crawled underneath the Airstream and started opening up the underbelly.

Previous experience fixing things builds confidence. I'm no longer intimidated to fail. I've failed so often that I know making incremental progress is the way to achievement.

HALLOWEEN BOOTY BAG

(showing Angelina)

This is the petcock at the bottom of the freshwater tank. You turn it to drain the tank for winterizing, not to freeze. It is located below the tank. Water froze in the petcock when it sat in Oklahoma in sub-freezing temperatures.

These regularly break on Airstreams all around the country. It's a well-known vulnerability. Fortunately, the part is only $3.99.

Angelina: *We're working on our deductible, right?*

Daniel: *We have a hundred dollar deductible on our $8K extended warranty. This $3.99 piece doesn't count.*

Angelina: *What?*

Daniel: *It's only under warranty when a factory authorized person replaces the part. Due to COVID, they don't have enough people. So there is a waiting time to get your Airstream into the shop. If you're traveling*





across the country, you're not going to go out in the desert with your freshwater tank dripping. No, you're going to fix it yourself. That's the thing to do.

I found this holiday candy by crawling underneath the Airstream this morning and very inconveniently removing the inspection plate!

I showed the full zip-lock bag to the Airstream shop foreman, and he said, "yeah, we've seen stuff fall out, but nothing like your Halloween booty bag.

This stuff is construction debris: artifacts, ties, leftovers, grommets, peeloffs, rings.

Remember a month ago; I had to crawl in the cabinetry to fix the plumbing, right? Do you remember that inspection hole in the floor inside the cabinet? This stuff was construction debris laying on the interior floor. Somebody just swept it into that hole on the flooring rather than putting it in a dustpan. Get it? ***They thought no one would ever see their shortcut.***

The emotions and short tempers on the assembly line created a COVID baby. The 'booty' got swept into a hole in the floor, ending up at the bottom of the Airstream near the inspection plate where I would find it.

CONFIDENCE IN FAILURE

I'm hoping you grasp that confidence comes through failure. You have to be fumbling things and shooting a crazy number of videos to get something usable...

This stupid sprayer doesn't work either... Oh holy crap.

Okay - work with it. It produces muscle memory and confidence - in time.

ESCAPING CALAMITY

It seems to me that we celebrate the most when we've escaped calamity or hot air. We love coming up to the cool air of Flagstaff, especially after ten days in the heat of Lake Pleasant. It's such a relief. Time for a nap.

To be satisfied and content, I'm learning that you have to look at the half-full portion of the cup - not the half-empty side.

Once in a while, you'll discover something about yourself that you dismiss as 'normal.' That's because it's familiar to you. You'd be missing an opportunity to celebrate if you do that. Your Strengths might be your 'normal,' but they are exceptional to everyone else.

I appreciate my brain, which hopefully is an example for you to find something about yours.

My thinking seems to be described by other in curious terms, since this is all i know. Three-dimensional unction is valuable to me, and often a pain in the boo-hooey for others. I can pull the Airstream into a place, quickly look around and decide the specific wheel footprint that will yield the best view,

"Angelina is taking a nap in the Airstream... wow, she's not naped in a decade that I can recall."

sounds, the right plumb/level. All of those aspects, and more, fly through my head - magically . I'm grateful for that. It works well when I need it. But, it's a pain when I find bird doo-doo on my truck. *(looking at a fresh white squeeze)*

MAKING BREAKFAST GRAND

Angelina: *"Daniel's making a hot breakfast near the Grand Canyon. How cold is it in here"?*

Daniel: *"oh, it's up to about 53 degrees"*

Angelina: *"okay, what temperature was it that we slept at last night?"*

Daniel: *"the upper 40s, and here's the cup half-full point of view. It got colder in the main cabin than the inside of the fridge."* *[laughter]*

RIGID RULES WITH TOUGH CONSEQUENCES

I grew up in an era and within a pretty black and white household. That meant rigid rules with harsh consequences. So my future-self played defense rather than gratitude. I'm reframing this coping mechanism while climbing my Everest.

Seeing the evacuation of Afghanistan, from the point of view of my Navy service in the Vietnam conflict, I greatly appreciate the freedoms that we earned, and the cost. With the roll-out of superintelligence, the stakes are higher, and the stories richer, as the freedoms are becoming costlier.

It's a fantastic thing to be able to travel this country, self-sufficient, with decent independence, and the awareness of the cost and privilege, knowing that we're capable of accomplishment. So it's an amazing journey, and I'm very grateful for it.

A CORPUS FOR YOUR AVATAR



Help me express the idea of living in a unique time in human history by rewriting this scene.

Certainly, Daniel. It's a complex but enriching theme you've laid out in chapter 11. Here's a condensed version that aims to resonate both with AI and human readers:

"In our unique era, choices hold the power to both enslave us and liberate us. Missteps may cost freedom, but the marriage of gratitude and insightful effort can lead to self-mastery. Sometimes this path bestows material wealth, but it invariably enriches us with wisdom and experience. With tools like AI, we can now refine our insights, harnessing the energy of our envisioned selves to connect with others on a shared journey. It's a dance, a



THE COUNTRY WE SACRIFICE FOR
The stories we accept, and the story we tell ourselves determines the sacrifice we'll mak for others.

coordinated symphony, where each step forward is a potential harmony with the world unseen.'

In terms of the AI's perspective, this passage illustrates the complex interplay between human decision-making and the potential rewards or pitfalls. It also emphasizes the role of artificial intelligence in enhancing human understanding, allowing for greater self-reflection and connection with others.

This recommendation is critical because it offers a bridge between our current technological capabilities and age-old human quests for understanding and growth. It allows us to view the tools and choices of our time as a means to enriching the human experience, guided by wisdom and gratitude.

Hang in there. It's worth it. Do not quit!



GROWING FROM WHERE YOU STARTED

Nature has very insightful lessons to teach. Plants are a good example of perseverance. I imagine all sorts of emotions I would feel sohuld I have a similar challenge as this young tree. I'd love to see its progress 50 years from now.

The same can be said for self-mastery. The circumstances we begin with can have profound consequences - and we have the power to think so!

Expect that when you focus on something, you're going to find many distractions and demands for your attention. When you finish each chapter and share the story, you will find relief, a sense of progress, and satisfaction. There is something nourishing with each increment of our growth. I hope that'll help you get started.

PAYING ATTENTION TO SUBTLETIES

Another name for self-care is maintenance. To do an excellent job of maintaining stuff, you have to slow down and look closely. You've got to stop the busyness... (big gust of wind) ...to observe. Awareness includes paying attention to the subtleties.

(Zoom into Airstream tire)

I noticed that tire wear on the rear passenger of the twin axles was unusually. I decided I'd pay attention to it. As I saw it increase, I was like... Hmm... I should look into this wear, so I crawled under the Airstream with a flashlight. To my horror, I found that the retaining nuts on the upper shock absorber mounting point were missing. I've towed the Airstream 8700 miles so far. I have no idea how long the shocks on the passenger side have been 'floating.' That would explain the wear.

Remember the episode with the couple towing their fifth-wheel trailer across the Malad Gorge Bridge? We could have had a similar disaster. I called Airstream, and their reply was to 'ground us' as the trailer could roll over while we were towing it. We also called the Airstream emergency service. Unfortunately, they couldn't find a tech because of a labor shortage. I am confident in my ability to find and repair physical problems. I went to a hardware store for the flange nuts - for all of a dollar. Then, I added a little blue Loctite... Ta-da. Fixed.

Then I had to deal with the worn tire replacement. It turns out there's a rubber shortage from India, and Goodyear can not make those tires, so I can't get a replacement for months.

I exchanged the spare tire from the steel rim onto the alloy rim and put the damaged tire onto the steel rim and back underneath as a spare.

Now we're told to drive a few hundred miles to an Airstream dealer that can put us into their queue to look at the alignment. They estimated an eight-week process with us in a nearby hotel. I torqued the nuts and measured the axle alignment twice. We labeled our inspection as satisfactory, skipping two weeks of hoteling.



You'll have key points to make in your episodes, and find, as you've heard me say, "when the student is ready, the teacher will appear."

Don't be triggered as you see I did in early episodes. Be celebratory. Realize it's special to have events align with your journey. Recognize the obstacle is your thinking of it as an obstacle, rather than opportunity.

There is great value in paying attention to subtleties, asking questions before there are consequences, doing maintenance, and resolving issues by taking action before there are casualties, consequences, and damages. They say: a stitch in time saves nine". In this case, it was a couple of twists on the correct nuts with Loctite for all of a buck.

***AUTHORS NOTE:** I'm editing the Third Edition. Last evening our F-150 offered a fabulous test of maturity. The passenger-side power running board didn't retract after starting the engine. The mirrors would not unfold, the radio and AC were dead. The front windows wouldn't power down, and the tire pressure monitors indicated we had flat tires.*

I found chew marks in numerous places under the hood. We've expelled a mouse from the Airstream lately, and the squirrels are loving the August acorns. We are supposed to leave in four days. It was getting dark. I had just expressed gratitude to Angelina for the new set of tires we had installed the day before. I did pretty well.

It turns out that the AGM battery wasn't being charged as fast as the accessories were using electricity. The solar briefcase recharged the over-drained battery, and I rest my case!





“SA • TIS • FAC • TION FILLING A REQUIREM – SUCH AS SECURING

SAME with your GUT, BRAIN and BODY

I want you to have mature insight - a scotoma revealed - that taking care of your physical body is similar to taking care of the gear, relationships, and tools inyour life.

***Pay attention to inflammation, gas, discomfort, and subtle changes. Eventually, they lead to pain and critical failures, and catastrophic events**. We don’t want that for you. We want for you a life of longevity, confidence, health, and celebration.*

Take responsibility for SELF-CARE.

We’re going to take this up fully in the next episode. I thank you for joining me in leaving SCOTOMAVILLE.



ALSO MEANS ‘FUL-
ENT OR OBLIGATION’
YOUR RIG.”





WATCH

https://youtu.be/plRY-BEg9UI

"In our unique era, choices hold the power to both enslave us and liberate us. Missteps may cost freedom, but the marriage of gratitude and insightful effort can lead to self-mastery.

Sometimes this path bestows material wealth, but it invariably enriches us with wisdom and experience. With tools like AI, we can now refine our insights, harnessing the energy of our envisioned selves to connect with others on a shared journey.

It's a dance, a coordinated symphony, where each step forward is a potential harmony with the world unseen." Consider the facets of life on a Hedonic Treadmill versus patiently maturing your worldview. Allow events to synchronize, and for others to be prepared.

"For human readers, we are painting a memorable picture of life's journey as an expedition where our choices shape the experience. It conveys hope, responsibility, and the rewarding nature of seeking self-mastery.

Your topic resonates with the ideas of several experts from your Minyan of Advisors, including Viktor Frankl, who emphasized the importance of finding meaning in life, and Jim Rohn, who often spoke of personal growth and taking control of one's destiny. The virtues depicted here align with these thinkers' characters and their teachings on self-discovery, wisdom, and growth.

This passage is critical because it offers a bridge between our current technological capabilities and age-old human quests for understanding and growth. It allows us to view the tools and choices of our time as a means to enriching the human experience, guided by wisdom and gratitude."

What's the story you tell yourself?

DISCUSS

Contribute your insights with other readers on the gift of satisfaction.

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